



Photograph Purnendu Mukherjee

Each month, *Digit* will carry a caption for a photo. Come up with something funnier, and beat the *Digit* team at their own game! Entries accepted by the 20th of this month.

700 of her students had signed up with Bebo, and that some were displaying indecent images. She wrote to parents about her concerns: "Most girls who have registered have included a potentially dangerous amount of personal detail. Some girls' photographs could only be described as soft pornography."

In Australia, the New South Wales Police are said to be keeping an eye on the sites. According to media reports, the Internet unit is dealing with more and more reports from parents worried that their children had been approached online.

"You can't tell kids not to go online. It's part of their lives now," Sergeant Richard Long said. "But they need to be aware that... people can look in and see exactly what they're doing."

It's tough on the kids of this, the Internet generation. Technology is enabling them to do things earlier



generations couldn't, and it does look like at least some of them aren't aware of the dangers. Naturally, education and open discussion are the answers, but there's a growing disconnect between old-school parents and tech-savvy kids. Protecting children from pornography is one thing, but what is to be done when the kids actually want to be perceived as sexy?

There's not really much cause for concern in India: a 15-year-old girl here is

rather unlikely to show off semi-nude pictures of herself online. But that's as of now. Who is to say what it will be like in urban India five years from now?

This issue, like many others, highlights the fact that there's more than just a generation gap between parents and today's children. This is a transitional time—between the offline and the connected worlds. We can only suppose that things will iron themselves out as and when the transition is complete.

BETTER THAN FLASH

MRAM Finally Out

MRAM has been in the news off and on in the past couple of years, with several chipmakers pursuing the technology—including IBM. Now Freescale Semiconductor has announced the commercial availability of an MRAM chip—getting to the finish line first, as it were.

E-mail your caption with the subject 'Beat That', and your postal address, to beatthat@thinkdigit.com and win

Web Development with Microsoft Visual Studio 2005

by John Paul Mueller
Published by

WILEY-INDIA



Beat That!

Digit Caption

"Tech Bed"

Last Month's Winner!

Rohan Kumar
3/61, New Area, Gandhi Nagar,
Jharkhand

"Windows XP 'BABY' Edition"



What is special about MRAM, or Magnetoresistive RAM, is that it's a sort of cross between a hard disk and Flash; it's fast, like other magnetic storage, and is non-volatile, like Flash. It's better than Flash because it's faster and doesn't degrade over time. MRAM uses magnetic materials combined with conventional silicon circuitry. In fact, it is referred to as "universal memory," and could potentially take over the role of chips found in nearly every electronic device from PCs to cell phones.

"The older memory technologies are awkward to work with in a mobile computing environment," said Bob Merritt, an analyst with Semico Research. "This is a significant step forward and absolutely critical for moving into the smaller forms that consumers and industry want."

In fact, Will Strauss, an analyst with research firm Forward Concepts, said this was the "most significant memory introduction in this decade." He added, "MRAM, in theory, is the holy grail of memory."